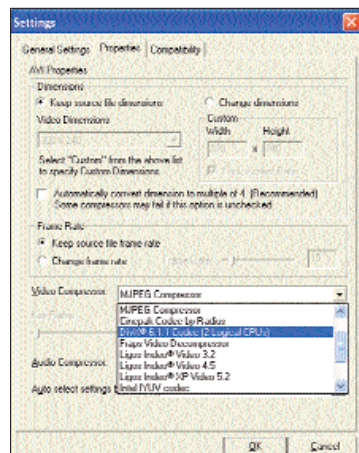


8. If you selected AVI as the conversion format, you can select from amongst the Best Quality, Best Compression or Most Compatible presets. In addition, you can also choose the video dimension, frame rate, video and audio compression codecs.

9. In a similar way, if you selected MPEG as the format,



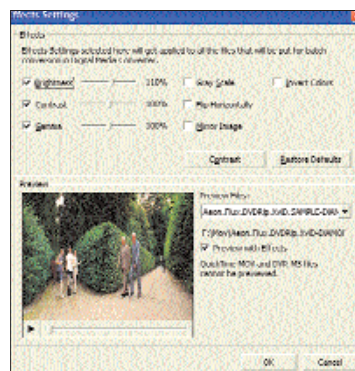
Select the AVI file codec as required

you can configure the properties. You can choose from amongst a myriad of MPEG-1 and MPEG-2 formats here such as VCD, SVCD, DVD, etc. You can also choose the aspect ratio, bitrate and frame rate. There are

options such as these for each format that you can choose, such as QuickTime.

10. To convert to the WMV format, point to the Tools menu and click on Settings. From the "Convert To" box, select WMV—For Desktop Viewing for Video, or WMA—For Desktop Viewing for audio. Select the Properties tab. From the Profile box, select a profile you feel is appropriate. From the list of available bitrates, select the ones you want to include in the conversion. When more than one bitrate is selected, the converted video is an MBR (Multiple bit rate) video. Click OK.

11. You can apply effects to the videos you convert. Select



Change the Effects Settings

the file to which you wish to apply a video effect. On the Tools menu, click Video Effects. Specify the effects that you want to apply in the Effect Settings window. Click OK.

12. The Brightness can be used to change the brightness level of the video. Up to a 200 per cent adjustment in brightness is available.

13. The Contrast allows you to adjust the contrast of the video to up to 200 per cent, allowing you to define the difference between the dark and light areas in case they do not appear in the video as they should.

14. The Gamma slider lets you adjust the gamma of the video by up to 200 per cent.

15. Videos can also be manipulated before they are converted. The Gray Scale effect transforms all the colours in the image into shades of grey, in effect converting colour videos to black and white.

16. "Flip Horizontally" turns the image ~upside down~. This can be useful in cases such as when the videos have been converted from the YUV colour space to the RGB colour space, which can sometimes result in the converted video turning upside down.

17. "Mirror Image" produces a mirror image of the video. This is also called the "Flip Vertically" effect, because it flips it about the vertical axis.

18. "Invert Colors" transforms the colours in the video to their negatives.

Digital Media Converter v2.65 is available from www.deskshare.com, and the download is about 9.4 MB. It is shareware and can be converted to the full version for \$39.95 (Rs 1,900). It can be picked up easily even if you are a novice. Start emptying out your hard drive! ■

jayesh_limaye@thinkdigit.com

India's First-Ever EPG

EPG, or Electronic Programming Guide, has just been launched by Microsoft in India. This will allow users of Windows XP Media Center Edition PCs easy access to program schedules for over 80 cable TV channels available in India.

An EPG is an on-screen interactive guide to TV programs that lets the user navigate, select, search for and record TV shows. Until now, this was only available in areas such as Europe and the US.

The EPG has a list of all the programs on your cable channels, and it will be integrated into all Windows XP

Media Center PCs from now on. Due to its interactive nature, you can look for your favourite shows just by typing in keywords such as the name of the program or movie, actor, time, day and date. You can also view the program start time, duration, censorship classification and genre. The EPG combined with the DVR (Digital Video Recording) capabilities of Windows XP Media Center transforms your PC into a PVR (Personal Video Recorder), allowing you to schedule recordings. The great thing is that this does not need a subscription—it's free!



80cm wide screen LCD TV, Media Centre PC,
High-end Gaming console,
450 hours of recording time
- All in One -

FUJITSU

DESKPOWER TX